NOTES

All weblinks in notes accessed last on 29 November 2021.
All listed designations of interviewees are accurate as of date of interview, unless otherwise stated.

Introduction

1. PTI, '1,000 BJP men held in Gujarat', *The Times of India*, 31 December 1988. Modi was then general secretary of the BJP's Gujarat unit. His name appeared twice earlier in the newspaper in the 1970s: in 1978 as a participant in a television programme, *Yuvadarshan*, on 'The youth struggle during the Emergency', and in 1979, where, as an RSS pracharak, he receives a cheque of Rs 5 lakh for work in relief camps after the Morvi dam disaster. 'Television', *The Times of India*, 23 May 1978; Staff Reporter, 'RSS Wing donates Rs 5 lakh', *The Times of India*, 2 October 1979.
2. Law Kumar Mishra, TOINS, 'Keep out, BJP tells police', *The Times of India*, 25 September 1990.
3. In June 2016, then Union minister of state for personnel and PMO, Jitendra Singh responded to a controversy on denial of government jobs to RSS members saying, 'the central government has not issued any such order [prohibiting government staff from joining RSS activities] recently', and 'if any old order exists, we will review it'. The RSS's publicity head, Manmohan Vaidya said, 'Banning RSS members from joining government service is unjust and undemocratic. Such bans hardly affect RSS work and morale of swayamsevaks.' By way of background: in 1964, the Union government brought in a rule under Central Civil Service (Conduct) Rules (Rule 5 (1)) stating